

# SIH\_2026\_Consumer\_Rights\_RAG

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*Retrieval-augmented knowledge base on consumer rights, legal awareness, complaints, remedies and sector-specific grievance escalation in India. This dataset is for general legal awareness and is not a substitute for advice from a qualified lawyer or regulator.*

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## Who is a Consumer

Consumer Protection Act, 2019

**Definition:** Under section 2(7) of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, a consumer is a person who buys goods or hires or avails services for consideration that has been paid, promised, partly paid and partly promised, or provided under a deferred-payment system. It includes an approved user of goods, but generally excludes a person who obtains goods for resale or for a commercial purpose.

**Important Exception:** The Act generally excludes commercial-purpose purchases, but a person who buys goods exclusively to earn livelihood by self-employment is treated differently under the statutory explanation. The facts of each case matter.

**Examples:**

- Buying a refrigerator for home use
- Paying for a mobile recharge
- Hiring a plumber for household repairs
- Buying a sewing machine for personal self-employment may require fact-specific analysis

**Not Normally Consumer Examples:**

- Buying goods for resale
- Buying machinery for a large commercial enterprise

**Hindi Expressions:**

- Main consumer hoon
- Kya main is maamle mein consumer hoon?
- Maine ghar ke liye saman kharida hai

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(7)*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/18555/1/consumer\\_protection\\_act\\_2019.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/18555/1/consumer_protection_act_2019.pdf)*

*Keywords: consumer, section 2(7), commercial purpose, resale, self employment*

## Six Rights of Consumers

Consumer Rights

**Rights:**

- Right to Safety: protection against goods and services hazardous to life and property
- Right to Information: information about quality, quantity, potency, purity, standard and price
- Right to Choice: access, wherever possible, to a variety of goods and services at competitive prices
- Right to be Heard: consumer interests must receive due consideration at appropriate forums
- Right to Seek Redressal: remedies against unfair or restrictive trade practices and exploitation
- Right to Consumer Awareness: awareness of consumer rights and available remedies

**Examples:**

**Safety:** Unsafe electrical appliances should not be sold

**Information:** A packaged product should provide legally required particulars such as MRP, net quantity and expiry or best-before information where applicable

**Choice:** A consumer should not be forced to buy an unwanted product as a condition of obtaining another product

**Heard:** A consumer can submit a grievance and supporting evidence to the seller, regulator or Consumer Commission

**Redressal:** A defective product may justify repair, replacement, refund or compensation depending on facts and the order

**Awareness:** Consumers should learn to check bills, terms, expiry dates, certifications and complaint channels

**Plain Language:** Consumer rights do not mean that every complaint automatically results in a refund. The consumer normally has to show the purchase or service relationship, the defect or deficiency, and the loss or unfair practice.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(9)*

Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New\\_Consumer\\_Protection\\_Act,\\_2019\\_-\\_FAQ\\_whatsnews.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New_Consumer_Protection_Act,_2019_-_FAQ_whatsnews.pdf),  
<https://www.consumerhelpline.gov.in/public/consumerrights>

Keywords: six rights, right to safety, right to information, right to redressal, consumer awareness

## Defect, Deficiency and Unfair Trade Practice

Consumer Protection Act, 2019

**Defect:** Section 2(10) defines defect as a fault, imperfection or shortcoming in the quality, quantity, potency, purity or standard required by law, contract, express or implied representation, or the trader's claim in relation to goods or products.

**Deficiency:** Section 2(11) defines deficiency as a fault, imperfection, shortcoming or inadequacy in the quality, nature or manner of performance required by law, contract or otherwise in relation to a service. It includes negligent acts or omissions causing loss or injury.

**Unfair Trade Practice:** Section 2(47) covers unfair or deceptive methods used to promote the sale or supply of goods or services. Examples include false claims about quality or quantity, misleading price representations, and refusing to take back defective goods or refund the price within the promised or stipulated period.

### Simple Difference:

**Defect:** Problem with a product, such as a phone that does not charge.

**Deficiency:** Problem with a service, such as a repair centre failing to perform the promised repair.

**Unfair Trade Practice:** Deception or unfair selling conduct, such as a fake discount or false quality claim.

Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(10), Section 2(11), Section 2(47)

Source: <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15276/1/210422.pdf>,  
[https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019\\_1732700731.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019_1732700731.pdf)

Keywords: defect, deficiency, unfair trade practice, section 2(10), section 2(11), section 2(47)

## Current Pecuniary Jurisdiction

Consumer Commissions

**Basis:** The current thresholds under the Consumer Protection (Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions) Rules, 2021 are based on the value of goods or services paid as consideration, not simply the compensation amount claimed.

**District Commission:** Up to and including ₹50 lakh

**State Commission:** Above ₹50 lakh and up to and including ₹2 crore

**National Commission:** Above ₹2 crore

**Warning:** Check the latest rules and applicable territorial jurisdiction before filing because statutory or regulatory changes may occur.

Legal reference: Consumer Protection (Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions) Rules, 2021, Consumer Protection Act, 2019, sections 34, 47 and 58

Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/232278.pdf>, [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse)

Keywords: jurisdiction, ₹50 lakh, ₹2 crore, district commission, state commission, NCDRC

## Where Can a Consumer Complaint Be Filed

Consumer Commissions

**General Rule:** A complaint may generally be filed before the Commission having territorial jurisdiction over the place where the opposite party resides or carries on business, where the cause of action arose, or where the complainant resides or personally works for gain, subject to the Act, rules and procedural requirements.

**Practical Advice:** For an online purchase, preserve the order address, seller details, payment record and delivery details. Use the official e-Jagriti or applicable Consumer Commission filing instructions to confirm the correct forum.

**Warning:** Jurisdiction questions can become fact-specific when there are multiple sellers, marketplaces, manufacturers, branches or contractual clauses.

Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019 and Consumer Protection (Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions) Rules, 2020, Section 34, Section 47, Section 58

Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse), <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/e-jagriti>

Keywords: territorial jurisdiction, place of residence, online purchase, cause of action, e-Jagriti

## Two-Year Limitation for Consumer Complaints

### Complaint Procedure

**Rule:** Under section 69 of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, a Consumer Commission complaint should ordinarily be filed within two years from the date on which the cause of action arose.

**Delay:** A delayed complaint may be admitted if the complainant satisfies the Commission that there was sufficient cause for the delay and the Commission records reasons for condoning it.

**Practical Advice:** Do not wait for years while repeatedly contacting the seller. Keep dated emails, complaint numbers, notices and proof of follow-up, and obtain legal advice when limitation may be close.

Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 69

Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/17038?view\\_type=browse&sam\\_handle=123456789/2510](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/17038?view_type=browse&sam_handle=123456789/2510), [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New\\_Consumer\\_Protection\\_Act,\\_2019\\_-\\_FAQ\\_whatsnews.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New_Consumer_Protection_Act,_2019_-_FAQ_whatsnews.pdf)

Keywords: limitation, two years, section 69, delay condonation, cause of action

## Step-by-Step Consumer Complaint Process

### Complaint Procedure

#### Steps:

- Identify the correct party or parties: seller, manufacturer, service provider, marketplace, insurer, bank or other responsible entity.
- Collect evidence: invoice, warranty, order page, payment proof, photographs, videos, emails, chats, call records, complaint numbers, inspection reports and delivery records.
- Send a clear written complaint to the trader or service provider. State the facts, the remedy requested and a reasonable response deadline.
- Use the National Consumer Helpline for pre-litigation assistance where appropriate.
- If unresolved, file before the appropriate Consumer Commission through the official e-Jagriti platform or the permitted offline process.
- State the facts chronologically, identify the defect, deficiency or unfair practice, list documents and specify the remedy sought.
- Attend or participate in proceedings as directed. Keep copies of filings, notices and orders.
- If an order is passed and not complied with, seek appropriate enforcement or execution remedies under the applicable procedure.

#### Evidence Examples:

- Invoice or receipt
- Screenshots of online order and product description
- UPI or card transaction record
- Defective product photographs or video
- Warranty card and service reports
- Emails and chat transcripts
- Courier or delivery proof
- Independent expert or laboratory report where technically necessary

#### Complaint Should Include:

- Names and addresses of complainant and opposite party
- Date and place of purchase or service
- Amount paid
- What was promised

- What went wrong
- Steps already taken
- Loss or injury suffered
- Relief requested
- List of supporting documents

**Important Note:** A National Consumer Helpline grievance is a pre-litigation grievance mechanism; it is not the same as filing a case before a Consumer Commission.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 35, Section 38, Section 39*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse), <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/e-jagriti>, <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>*

*Keywords: complaint process, consumer case, e-Jagriti, documents, legal notice, evidence*

## What Relief Can a Consumer Commission Grant

Remedies and Compensation

### Possible Reliefs:

- Removal of defects from goods
- Replacement of goods
- Refund of price paid, with interest where justified
- Removal of deficiency in service
- Compensation for loss or injury caused by negligence or deficiency
- Discontinuance of unfair or restrictive trade practice
- Withdrawal of hazardous goods from sale
- Discontinuance of manufacture or provision of hazardous goods or services
- Corrective advertisement for a misleading advertisement
- Costs of litigation or proceedings where justified

**Plain Language:** The Commission chooses relief based on evidence, contract terms, the nature of the defect or deficiency, actual loss and applicable law. A consumer should not assume that a full refund, replacement or punitive compensation is automatic.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 39*

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New\\_Consumer\\_Protection\\_Act,\\_2019\\_-\\_FAQ\\_whatsnews.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/admin/cmsfiles/whatsnews/New_Consumer_Protection_Act,_2019_-_FAQ_whatsnews.pdf), [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse)*

*Keywords: refund, replacement, compensation, repair, corrective advertisement, section 39*

## Consumer Mediation

Complaint Procedure

**Meaning:** Mediation is a settlement process in which a mediator helps the parties try to resolve the dispute. It is different from a contested adjudication.

**Practical Point:** If a matter is referred to mediation, read the proposed settlement carefully. Do not sign a settlement that does not clearly state payment amount, date, refund method, repair or replacement obligations, and consequences of default.

**Warning:** Mediation is not suitable for every dispute, especially where urgent safety, fraud, criminal conduct or a strong need for an authoritative finding is involved.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(25), Sections 74 to 81*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/18555/1/consumer\\_protection\\_act\\_2019.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/18555/1/consumer_protection_act_2019.pdf)*

*Keywords: mediation, settlement, consumer mediator, sections 74 to 81*

## e-Jagriti and Online Consumer Commission Filing

Digital Complaint Filing

**Purpose:** e-Jagriti is the Department of Consumer Affairs platform and resource system for consumer-related digital services and Consumer Commission case filing.

**Steps:**

- Open the official e-Jagriti information or filing platform.
- Create an account using the required identity and contact details.
- Select the appropriate Consumer Commission and complaint type.
- Enter parties, facts, reliefs and case value.
- Upload readable documents and pay any applicable fee shown by the official portal.
- Save the filing acknowledgement, diary or case number and monitor notices.

**Warning:** Portal names, links, filing workflows and technical requirements can change. Use the current official Department of Consumer Affairs or Consumer Commission portal rather than unofficial websites.

Source: <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/e-jagriti>, <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/consumer-protection-unit-consumer-commission>, <https://edaakhil.nic.in/edaakhil/>

Keywords: e-Jagriti, e-Daakhil, online consumer case, digital filing, consumer commission portal

## National Consumer Helpline

Authorities

**Role:** The National Consumer Helpline is a Department of Consumer Affairs pre-litigation grievance mechanism. It can facilitate communication with participating companies and help consumers understand possible channels, but it does not replace a Consumer Commission, regulator, police investigation or court.

**Phone Numbers:**

- 1915
- 1800 11 4000

**Timings:** 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM on all days except national holidays, according to the official contact page

**Channels:**

- Web portal
- NCH consumer app
- UMANG
- WhatsApp: 8800001915
- SMS: 8800001915
- Email: [nch-ca@gov.in](mailto:nch-ca@gov.in)

**Documents:**

- Invoice or order number
- Payment proof
- Written communication with seller
- Photographs or screenshots
- Warranty or policy documents

**Practical Advice:** Ask for and preserve the docket number. If the grievance remains unresolved, consider the relevant regulator, police or Consumer Commission rather than repeatedly opening identical tickets.

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/about-portal.php>, <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/public/contact>, <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/nch>

Keywords: NCH, 1915, 1800 11 4000, INGRAM, consumer helpline, docket number

## Defective Product: Repair, Replacement or Refund

Products and Warranties

**Process:**

- Stop using a product that may be unsafe.
- Photograph the product, serial number, packaging, defect and any resulting damage.

- Contact the seller and manufacturer or authorised service centre in writing.
- Quote the invoice, warranty and promised specifications.
- Ask clearly for repair, replacement or refund and state a response deadline.
- Keep the product available for inspection and do not destroy or alter evidence.
- If unresolved, use NCH or file before the Consumer Commission.

**Legal Position:** A Consumer Commission may order removal of defects, replacement, refund, compensation or other relief under section 39. The appropriate remedy depends on the evidence, warranty terms, seriousness of the defect, repair history and loss caused.

**Warranty Note:** A warranty is a contractual promise with stated terms and duration. It does not automatically guarantee replacement of the entire product or a refund in every case. Read exclusions, service conditions and proof-of-purchase requirements.

**Sample Request:** The product delivered on [date] does not match the promised specification and has the following defect: [facts]. I request [repair/replacement/refund] under the warranty and applicable consumer law. Please respond in writing by [date].

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(10), Section 2(20), Section 2(47), Section 39*

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019\\_1732700731.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019_1732700731.pdf),  
[https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse)*

*Keywords: defective product, warranty, repair, replacement, refund, service centre*

## Warranty, Guarantee and Repair Rights

### Products and Warranties

**Warranty:** A warranty is generally a written promise regarding repair, replacement, parts or service for a stated period and under specified conditions.

**Guarantee:** A guarantee may be a stronger promise, but its legal effect depends on the wording, contract, product representation and applicable law.

#### Consumer Checklist:

- Confirm whether the promise is from the manufacturer, seller or service provider.
- Check duration, exclusions, accidental-damage conditions and inspection requirements.
- Keep the invoice, warranty card, serial number and service job sheets.
- Ask for a written reason if a claim is rejected.
- Do not accept an oral refusal as the final position; request email or job-sheet remarks.

**Important Case Awareness:** Frequent repairs alone may not prove a manufacturing defect, and a vehicle warranty may entitle the consumer only to replacement of defective parts under its terms rather than automatic replacement of the entire vehicle or refund. The result depends on facts and evidence.

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E-digest%20of%20Judgments\\_1767084682.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E-digest%20of%20Judgments_1767084682.pdf),  
[https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019\\_1732700731.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019_1732700731.pdf)*

*Keywords: warranty, guarantee, repair rights, manufacturing defect, service job sheet*

## Online Shopping, Marketplace and E-Commerce Rights

### Digital/E-Commerce

#### Common Problems:

- Non-delivery after payment
- Wrong, fake, used or damaged product
- Product materially different from listing
- Seller refusing return or refund
- Cancellation without refund
- Extra charges at checkout
- Unclear seller identity or grievance contact
- Fake reviews or manipulated ratings

### Practical Steps:

- Save the product page, seller details, order confirmation, invoice, payment record and delivery-unboxing video where possible.
- Complain through the platform and separately identify the seller, marketplace and manufacturer where relevant.
- Use the platform grievance officer details displayed on the website or app.
- Ask for a written explanation and refund or replacement.
- Escalate to NCH, CCPA or Consumer Commission as appropriate.

**Legal Rule:** The Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020 require e-commerce entities to maintain a grievance redressal mechanism and appoint a grievance officer whose name and contact details must be displayed. The grievance officer should acknowledge a consumer complaint within 48 hours and redress it within one month.

**Marketplace Note:** A marketplace and a seller may have different legal roles. Identify all relevant parties from the invoice, listing and terms instead of assuming that only the app is responsible.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020*

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules\\_1732703966.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules_1732703966.pdf),  
<https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/consumer-protection-acts>*

*Keywords: e-commerce, marketplace, online shopping, non delivery, wrong product, grievance officer, 48 hours, one month*

## Online Non-Delivery

### Scenarios

**Problem:** Consumer paid online but the product was never delivered.

#### Evidence:

- Payment receipt
- Order confirmation email
- Order page and promised delivery date
- Seller and platform details
- Customer-care complaint number

#### Remedy:

- Ask the platform and seller for delivery or full refund in writing.
- Use the e-commerce grievance officer and NCH.
- If unresolved, file a Consumer Commission complaint for deficiency in service and appropriate refund or compensation.

**Hindi Expression:** Maine paisa diya, saman nahi aaya

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019; Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020*

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules\\_1732703966.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules_1732703966.pdf),  
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15276/1/210422.pdf>*

*Keywords: non delivery, online order, refund, deficiency of service*

## Wrong, Fake or Damaged Product Delivery

### Scenarios

**Problem:** The consumer ordered one product but received another product, a counterfeit product or a damaged product.

#### Evidence:

- Product listing screenshot
- Invoice
- Package label and barcode
- Unboxing video or delivery photographs
- Return request and rejection message

#### Remedy:

- Do not use the product if it may be unsafe or counterfeit.
- Raise return or replacement request immediately.

- Preserve packaging and courier labels.
- Ask for refund including eligible delivery charges.
- Escalate to platform grievance officer, NCH, CCPA or Consumer Commission.

**Hindi Expression:** Order mobile kiya tha, soap mila

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019; Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020*

*Source: [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019\\_1732700731.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/CP%20Act%202019_1732700731.pdf),*

*[https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules\\_1732703966.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules_1732703966.pdf)*

*Keywords: wrong product, counterfeit, damaged delivery, return, refund*

## Dark Patterns and Deceptive Interfaces

Digital/E-Commerce

**Meaning:** A dark pattern is a user-interface design or practice that deceives, manipulates or substantially impairs a consumer's ability to make a free and informed choice.

**Official Examples:**

- False urgency
- Basket sneaking
- Confirm shaming
- Forced action
- Subscription trap
- Interface interference
- Bait and switch
- Drip pricing
- Disguised advertisements
- Nagging
- Trick wording
- SaaS billing
- Rogue malware

**Consumer Actions:**

- Take screenshots before completing payment.
- Record the advertised price and final checkout price.
- Look for pre-ticked add-ons, automatic renewals and hidden cancellation steps.
- Cancel unwanted subscriptions and ask for refund promptly.
- Report the practice to the platform, NCH or CCPA and preserve evidence.

**Remedy:** A consumer may pursue refund or other relief under applicable consumer law. The CCPA may investigate and act against prohibited practices under its statutory powers.

*Legal reference: Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023*

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/file-uploads/latestnews/central-consumer-protection-authority-dark-patterns-guidelines-wa-termark-1565354.pdf>*

*Keywords: dark patterns, basket sneaking, subscription trap, drip pricing, false urgency, CCPA*

## Misleading Advertisements and Endorsements

Advertising and CCPA

**Examples:**

- False claim about quality, performance, purity or safety
- Claiming a product is free when mandatory charges are hidden
- Showing a fake or inflated reference price
- Using an unsubstantiated health, education, investment or employment claim
- Influencer endorsement without disclosing a material commercial connection

- Advertisement that omits material information likely to mislead consumers

#### **Consumer Actions:**

- Save the advertisement URL, date, screenshots, video and transaction record.
- Complain to the seller or advertiser.
- Report to CCPA or NCH.
- Seek appropriate refund or compensation before the Consumer Commission where the advertisement caused a purchase or loss.

**Endorsement Rule:** The 2022 guidelines require due diligence by endorsers. An endorsement should reflect the genuine and reasonably current opinion of the endorser, be based on adequate information or experience, not be deceptive, and disclose a material connection that the audience would not reasonably expect.

*Legal reference: Guidelines for Prevention of Misleading Advertisements and Endorsements for Misleading Advertisements, 2022*

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/regulations-made-under-consumer-protection-act-2019>, <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/Consumer%20Protection%20Act,%202019%20protects%20consumers%20involved%20in%20online%20transactions%20English.pdf>*

*Keywords: misleading advertisement, endorsement, influencer, CCPA, fake claim, fake discount*

## **Fake or Inflated Discount**

### **Scenarios**

**Problem:** A seller increases the reference price and then displays a large discount, or advertises a discount that is not available at checkout.

#### **Evidence:**

- Advertisement screenshot
- Checkout screenshot
- Invoice
- Price history from reliable records
- Date and time of the offer

#### **Remedy:**

- Ask the seller to honour the displayed offer or refund the overcharge where appropriate.
- Report misleading advertisement or deceptive pricing to CCPA or NCH.
- File a Consumer Commission complaint if a purchase and loss occurred.

**Hindi Expression:** Discount jhootha hai

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019; Misleading Advertisements and Endorsements Guidelines, 2022, Section 2(47), Section 18*

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/Consumer%20Protection%20Act,%202019%20protects%20consumers%20involved%20in%20online%20transactions%20English.pdf>, <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/regulations-made-under-consumer-protection-act-2019>*

*Keywords: fake discount, inflated price, misleading advertisement, drip pricing*

## **Subscription Trap and Auto-Renewal**

### **Scenarios**

**Problem:** A consumer unknowingly enrolled in an auto-renewing subscription or found cancellation much harder than sign-up.

#### **Evidence:**

- Subscription screen
- Terms and conditions
- Email or SMS confirmation
- Bank or card statement
- Cancellation attempt screenshots

#### **Remedy:**

- Cancel the subscription through the provider and payment instrument.
- Ask for confirmation that auto-renewal has stopped.
- Demand refund for an unauthorised or inadequately disclosed charge.

- Complain to the platform, NCH or CCPA and consider a Consumer Commission complaint if money was lost.

**Safety Note:** Do not share OTP, UPI PIN, card PIN or remote-access credentials while seeking a refund.

*Legal reference: Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023*

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/file-uploads/latestnews/central-consumer-protection-authority-dark-patterns-guidelines-wa-termark-1565354.pdf>*

*Keywords: subscription trap, auto renewal, recurring payment, refund, dark pattern*

## Hidden Charges and Drip Pricing

Scenarios

**Problem:** Extra charges appear only at the final checkout stage or are not clearly disclosed before payment.

**Evidence:**

- Initial price screenshot
- Cart and checkout screenshots
- Invoice
- Terms displayed at the time of purchase

**Remedy:**

- Ask for reversal of undisclosed charges.
- Use the platform grievance mechanism and NCH.
- Report suspected drip pricing or unfair practice to CCPA.
- Claim refund or compensation before the Consumer Commission if loss occurred.

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019; Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023*

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/file-uploads/latestnews/central-consumer-protection-authority-dark-patterns-guidelines-wa-termark-1565354.pdf>, <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15276/1/210422.pdf>*

*Keywords: hidden charges, drip pricing, checkout, unfair trade practice*

## Banking Complaints and Escalation

Sector-Specific

**Problems:**

- Unexplained charges
- Failed UPI transactions
- Unauthorised electronic transactions
- Cash not received but account debited
- Wrong interest or loan charges
- Unfair recovery conduct
- Credit-card billing dispute
- Failure to close account or issue documents

**First Step:** Complain to the bank, regulated entity, card issuer or payment service provider through its official grievance channel. Obtain a complaint number.

**Escalation:** If the regulated entity rejects the complaint, does not reply within 30 days, or the response is unsatisfactory, use the RBI Complaint Management System under the Integrated Ombudsman Scheme where the entity and matter are covered.

**Evidence:**

- Bank statement
- Transaction ID or UTR
- ATM slip
- SMS or email alert
- Screenshots
- Written complaint and bank response

**Remedy Note:** Consumer Commission remedies and RBI regulatory grievance mechanisms may overlap in some situations, but the correct forum depends on the entity, transaction and relief sought. Fraud should also be reported to police or the cybercrime system.

Source: <https://www.rbi.org.in/CommonPerson/english/Scripts/PressReleases.aspx?Id=3340>,  
<https://www.rbi.org.in/commonperson/english/scripts/FAQs.aspx?Id=3407>, <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>  
Keywords: banking complaint, RBI Ombudsman, CMS, bank charges, grievance officer, 30 days

## RBI Integrated Ombudsman Scheme

Banking and Financial Services

### Eligibility Sequence:

- First complain in writing to the concerned bank, NBFC or covered payment system participant.
- Wait for the entity's reply or the expiry of 30 days if there is no reply.
- If the reply is unsatisfactory or absent, file through the RBI Complaint Management System, subject to the Scheme's coverage and exclusions.

### Channels:

- Online: <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>
- Contact Centre: 14448, with hours and language availability as stated by RBI
- Email or physical filing through the RBI Centralised Receipt and Processing Centre, as specified by RBI

### Documents:

- Original complaint to the regulated entity
- Acknowledgement or complaint number
- Entity response, if any
- Statement and transaction records
- Identity and contact details

**Warning:** Do not file an RBI Ombudsman complaint before first approaching the regulated entity unless a current RBI rule provides otherwise. The Scheme contains grounds and exclusions; check the current RBI FAQ.

Source: <https://www.rbi.org.in/CommonPerson/english/Scripts/PressReleases.aspx?Id=3340>,  
<https://www.rbi.org.in/commonperson/english/scripts/FAQs.aspx?Id=3407>, <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>  
Keywords: Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, RBI CMS, 14448, 30 days, bank escalation

## Unauthorised Bank or Card Transaction

Banking and Digital Payments

### Immediate Steps:

- Notify the bank, card issuer, wallet or payment provider immediately through its official channel.
- Block the card or account instrument if necessary.
- Change credentials and secure the account, but do not share OTP or PIN with anyone claiming to help.
- Report financial cyber fraud immediately at 1930 and <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>.
- Preserve transaction IDs, SMS, emails, screenshots and complaint acknowledgements.

**Rbi Rule:** Under RBI's customer-protection framework, zero liability can arise in specified situations including bank contributory fraud, negligence or deficiency, and certain third-party breaches where the customer notifies the bank within three working days of receiving the bank's communication. Liability can differ when the customer delays or shares credentials, so report immediately.

**Warning:** A transaction that the customer personally authorised after being deceived may involve different facts from a completely unauthorised transaction. Report both to the bank and cybercrime authorities.

Source: <https://www.rbi.org.in/commonman/english/scripts/Notification.aspx?Id=2336>, <https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/FAQView.aspx?Id=153>,  
<https://cybercrime.gov.in/>, [https://cybercrime.gov.in/Webform/Crime\\_NodalGrievanceList.aspx](https://cybercrime.gov.in/Webform/Crime_NodalGrievanceList.aspx)  
Keywords: unauthorised transaction, bank fraud, zero liability, 1930, cybercrime, OTP scam

## Failed UPI Transaction or Amount Debited

Banking and Digital Payments

**Problem:** A UPI payment failed, but the customer's bank account was debited or the merchant did not receive the money.

**Steps:**

- Record the UPI transaction ID, date, amount, payer bank, receiver or merchant details and error message.
- Raise a complaint in the UPI app and with the bank account provider.
- If the transaction involved a merchant, also preserve the order or service record.
- Escalate through the bank's grievance process and then RBI CMS if the bank or covered entity does not resolve the matter.

**Timing Note:** Applicable NPCI and RBI turnaround rules vary by transaction type and may be updated. For a failed UPI merchant transaction, NPCI material has specified reversal or return timelines in relevant circulars; check the current bank or NPCI rule for the exact transaction category rather than relying on a generic deadline.

**Fraud Warning:** If the payment was caused by phishing, impersonation, a fake QR code or unauthorised access, report immediately to the bank and 1930. A normal failed transaction is not automatically a cyber fraud.

Source: <https://www.npci.org.in/upi-complaint>, [https://www.npci.org.in/PDF/npci/imps/circular/2019/IMPS-UPI-I-OC-93-I-FY-19-20-I-Harmonisation-of-Turn-Around-Time\(TAT\)-and-customer-compensation-for-failed-transaction.pdf](https://www.npci.org.in/PDF/npci/imps/circular/2019/IMPS-UPI-I-OC-93-I-FY-19-20-I-Harmonisation-of-Turn-Around-Time(TAT)-and-customer-compensation-for-failed-transaction.pdf), <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>, <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>

Keywords: UPI, failed transaction, amount debited, NPCI, transaction ID, refund

## ATM Cash Not Received but Account Debited

Scenarios

**Problem:** Cash was not dispensed, or less cash was dispensed, but the account was debited.

**Evidence:**

- ATM slip
- Bank SMS
- Account statement
- ATM location and number
- Date, time and transaction reference

**Remedy:**

- Complain to the card-issuing bank immediately.
- Keep the complaint acknowledgement.
- For a failed ATM transaction, RBI material states that re-credit should generally occur within T+5 calendar days and delay beyond that can attract ₹100 per day compensation, subject to the applicable rule.
- Escalate to RBI CMS if the bank does not resolve the complaint after the required precondition.

**Hindi Expression:** ATM se cash nahi nikla, par paisa kat gaya

Source: <https://www.rbi.org.in/commonman/English/Scripts/FAQs.aspx?Id=497>, <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>

Keywords: ATM, cash not dispensed, T+5, ₹100 per day, bank complaint

## Cyber Financial Fraud

Scenarios

**Problem:** A consumer loses money through phishing, impersonation, fake customer care, UPI collect request, remote-access app, QR code deception or another online fraud.

**Immediate Remedy:**

- Call 1930 immediately.
- Report at <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>.
- Notify the bank, wallet, card issuer or payment provider immediately and request transaction blocking or recall.
- Preserve all messages, call numbers, URLs, transaction IDs, screenshots and device evidence.
- Complete the online report and follow the acknowledgement instructions.

**Important Distinction:** Cybercrime reporting is not the same as a consumer complaint. The police and cybercrime system is needed for investigation and freezing funds; a regulator or Consumer Commission may be relevant for service deficiency or failure by a regulated entity, depending on the facts.

**Evidence:**

- Mobile number used by fraudster
- Bank or wallet name
- Account or UPI ID
- Transaction ID and date
- Screenshots
- Chat, email or call details

Source: <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>, [https://cybercrime.gov.in/uploadmedia/instructions\\_citizenreportingcyberfrauds.pdf](https://cybercrime.gov.in/uploadmedia/instructions_citizenreportingcyberfrauds.pdf), <https://www.npci.org.in/upi-complaint>

Keywords: cyber fraud, 1930, National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, UPI scam, phishing, fake customer care

## Insurance Complaints

Sector-Specific

**Problems:**

- Claim rejection without a clear policy-based reason
- Delay in claim settlement
- Hidden exclusions or mis-selling
- Incorrect premium or policy details
- Failure to provide policy documents
- Unfair renewal or cancellation conduct

**Steps:**

- Read the policy schedule, wording, exclusions, endorsements and claim conditions.
- Complain first to the insurer's grievance redressal officer and keep proof.
- If unresolved, approach IRDAI through Bima Bharosa.
- If eligible, approach the Insurance Ombudsman within the applicable time limit.
- A Consumer Commission may also be relevant for deficiency in service, subject to facts, jurisdiction and other legal requirements.

**Evidence:**

- Policy document and schedule
- Premium receipts
- Claim form
- Surveyor or investigation correspondence
- Medical or repair records
- Insurer's rejection letter
- Grievance acknowledgement

Source: <https://irdai.gov.in/grievance-redressal-mechanism1>, <https://bimabharosa.irdai.gov.in/>, <https://irdai.gov.in/ombudsman>

Keywords: insurance, IRDAI, Bima Bharosa, Insurance Ombudsman, claim rejection, policy exclusion

## IRDAI Bima Bharosa and Insurance Ombudsman

Insurance

**Irdai Channels:**

- Bima Bharosa portal: <https://bimabharosa.irdai.gov.in/>
- Toll-free: 155255
- Toll-free: 1800 4254 732
- Email: [complaints@irdai.gov.in](mailto:complaints@irdai.gov.in)

**Ombudsman Precondition:** Under the Insurance Ombudsman Rules, a complaint generally requires a prior written representation to the insurer. The Ombudsman route may be available after an unsatisfactory rejection or decision, or after one month passes without a response.

**Time Limit:** IRDAI's FAQ states that an Insurance Ombudsman complaint should generally be made within one year from the insurer's rejection, unsatisfactory decision or expiry of one month after the written representation where the insurer has not replied.

**Warning:** Check current monetary, territorial, subject-matter and procedural eligibility before filing because Insurance Ombudsman rules and limits can change.

*Legal reference: Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017*

*Source: <https://irdai.gov.in/igms1>, <https://irdai.gov.in/documents/37343/379608/FAQ%E2%80%99s+on+Insurance+Ombudsman+Rules+2017.pdf/37bc4077-6906-91ad-fb49-6c0e733b3e0d?version=3.0&t=1640147675026>, <https://irdai.gov.in/ombudsman>*

*Keywords: IRDAI, Bima Bharosa, Insurance Ombudsman, one year, insurer grievance*

## Telecom Complaints and Escalation

Sector-Specific

### Problems:

- Overcharging
- Wrong plan activation
- Unwanted value-added services
- Poor network or promised service not delivered
- Broadband speed or frequent disconnection
- Unwanted commercial communication
- Failure to port or close service correctly

**First Step:** Complain to the telecom service provider's complaint centre and obtain a docket or complaint number. The provider's customer-care channel and complaint timelines depend on the applicable TRAI regulations and service.

**Appeal:** If the complaint is unresolved or the response is unsatisfactory, appeal to the service provider's Appellate Authority. TRAI's official guidance states that an appeal is generally filed within 30 days after expiry of the complaint-redressal time limit, and the appellate authority generally disposes of it in approximately 39 days.

**Trai Role:** TRAI generally does not directly decide an individual consumer complaint; it provides the regulatory complaint and appellate framework and publishes service-provider contact details.

*Source: <https://www.trai.gov.in/faqcategory/redressal-consumer-grievances>, <https://www.trai.gov.in/consumer-info/cgr/appellate-authority>, <https://tccms.trai.gov.in/>*

*Keywords: TRAI, telecom, 198, Appellate Authority, docket number, broadband*

## Wrong Mobile Plan or Telecom Bill

Scenarios

**Problem:** The consumer requested a ₹299 plan but a ₹499 plan was activated, or the bill includes services or charges not requested.

### Evidence:

- Plan-selection screenshot
- SMS confirmation
- Recharge or payment receipt
- Bill
- Complaint docket number

### Remedy:

- Complain to the provider and ask for reversal, correction or refund.
- If unresolved, appeal to the provider's Appellate Authority, including the complaint number and proof.
- Consider NCH or a Consumer Commission where the facts establish deficiency or unfair practice.

## Hindi Expression: Mere mobile bill galat hai

Source: <https://www.trai.gov.in/faqcategory/redressal-consumer-grievances>, <https://www.trai.gov.in/consumer-info/cgr/appellate-authority>

Keywords: wrong plan, telecom bill, VAS, TRAI appeal, refund

## Food Product Complaints

Sector-Specific

### Problems:

- Adulterated or unsafe food
- Expired or spoiled packaged food
- Misleading food label or health claim
- Quantity less than declared
- Poor packaging or contamination
- Unlicensed food business

### Steps:

- Do not consume suspected unsafe food and preserve the packaging, batch number, bill and photographs.
- For immediate health danger, seek medical care and preserve medical records.
- Report food safety concerns through FSSAI Food Safety Connect portal or app and, where appropriate, the State Food Safety Commissioner.
- For refund, compensation or service deficiency, use the seller's grievance mechanism, NCH or Consumer Commission.

### Evidence:

- Bill
- Packaging and batch number
- Expiry or best-before details
- Photographs
- Laboratory or medical report where relevant
- FSSAI complaint number

Source: <https://fssai.gov.in/food-safety-connect>, <https://fssai.gov.in/about-us/grievance>, <https://fssai.gov.in/faqs/?p=1721>

Keywords: FSSAI, food safety, adulteration, expired food, Food Safety Connect, packaged food

## Adulterated or Unsafe Food

Scenarios

**Problem:** Food appears contaminated, adulterated, spoiled or unsafe, or causes illness.

### Evidence:

- Remaining food and original packaging, if safe to preserve
- Batch, lot and expiry details
- Bill or delivery record
- Photographs
- Medical records
- Laboratory report where obtained through an appropriate process

### Remedy:

- Stop consuming the product.
- Seek medical attention where necessary.
- Report to FSSAI Food Safety Connect and the State Food Safety authority.
- Ask the seller or manufacturer for a written response and refund.
- Use NCH or Consumer Commission for consumer remedies where appropriate.

### Source Urls:

- <https://fssai.gov.in/food-safety-connect>

- <https://fssai.gov.in/about-us/grievance>

#### Queries:

- Food caused illness what complaint can I file?
- Adulterated food report India
- Expired food purchased from shop
- FSSAI Food Safety Connect complaint

#### Keywords:

- adulterated food
- food poisoning
- FSSAI
- unsafe food
- medical evidence

## Short Weight, Quantity and MRP

Weights, Measures and Pricing

**Rule:** The Legal Metrology Act, 2009 and the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules regulate declarations and standards for pre-packaged commodities. A pre-packaged commodity must carry prescribed declarations, including relevant quantity and price information.

#### Consumer Actions:

- Check net quantity, MRP, manufacturer or packer details, batch and date information.
- Ask for a bill and do not accept a higher price than the applicable MRP for a packaged commodity, subject to legally permitted circumstances.
- Photograph the package and obtain a weighing record where possible.
- Complain to the State Legal Metrology or Weights and Measures authority and use NCH or Consumer Commission for refund or compensation.

**Warning:** Rules may differ for loose goods, services, taxes, delivery charges and specific product categories. The applicable MRP and charging circumstances should be checked carefully.

*Legal reference: Legal Metrology Act, 2009; Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011, Section 18 of the Legal Metrology Act, 2009*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology\\_act\\_2009.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology_act_2009.pdf),*

*[https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/123789/1/legal\\_metrology\\_package\\_commodities\\_rules\\_2011.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/123789/1/legal_metrology_package_commodities_rules_2011.pdf)*

*Keywords: short quantity, short weight, MRP, Legal Metrology, packaged commodity, net quantity*

## Short Quantity or Weight

Scenarios

**Problem:** Consumer receives 900 grams instead of 1 kilogram, or a packaged product contains less than the declared quantity.

#### Evidence:

- Weighing-scale photograph or video
- Package label
- Bill copy
- Shop or seller details
- Independent weighing or inspection record where feasible

#### Remedy:

- Ask the seller to correct the quantity or refund the shortfall.
- Report to the State Legal Metrology department.
- Use NCH or Consumer Commission for consumer relief if loss or unfair practice is established.

**Hindi Expression:** Ek kilo ke paise diye, kam saman mila

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology\\_act\\_2009.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology_act_2009.pdf)*

*Keywords: short weight, short quantity, weighing scale, Legal Metrology*

## BIS Mark, ISI Mark and Hallmark Complaints

Standards and Product Safety

### Consumer Checks:

- Use the BIS Care app to verify licence details for products bearing a BIS mark where the feature applies.
- Use the Verify HUID feature for hallmarked jewellery.
- Do not assume that a printed or imitation ISI symbol is a genuine BIS certification.
- Keep the invoice, product photographs, mark, licence number or HUID and seller details.

**Complaints:** BIS states that complaints can be made online or offline through its consumer channels, including its portal, email, mobile app or nearest Branch Office. Suspected misuse or counterfeit ISI marking may also be reported to BIS.

**Remedy Note:** BIS regulatory action and consumer compensation are different issues. A consumer may separately seek refund, replacement or compensation through the seller, NCH or Consumer Commission.

Source: <https://www.bis.gov.in/consumer-overview/consumer-overviews/for-consumers-faq/>, <https://www.bis.gov.in/bis-apps/?lang=en>, <https://www.bis.gov.in/other/enforcement.htm>, <https://www.bis.gov.in/hallmarking-overview/consumer-protection/?lang=en>

Keywords: BIS, ISI mark, hallmark, HUID, BIS Care, counterfeit certification

## Insurance Claim Rejected

Scenarios

**Problem:** An insurer rejects a claim or pays less than expected without giving a satisfactory policy-based explanation.

### Evidence:

- Policy schedule and wording
- Claim form
- Insurer's rejection or settlement letter
- Surveyor report
- Premium payment evidence
- Medical, repair or loss documents

### Remedy:

- Request the precise clause and facts relied upon for rejection.
- Submit a written representation to the insurer grievance officer.
- Escalate to IRDAI Bima Bharosa.
- Consider Insurance Ombudsman eligibility and deadline.
- Consider Consumer Commission advice where deficiency in service is alleged.

**Hindi Expression:** Insurance claim bina wajah reject kar diya

Source: <https://irdai.gov.in/grievance-redressal-mechanism1>, <https://bimabharosa.irdai.gov.in/>, <https://irdai.gov.in/ombudsman>

Keywords: claim rejection, policy exclusion, IRDAI, Insurance Ombudsman, Bima Bharosa

## Healthcare and Hospital Complaints

Sector-Specific

### Problems:

- Overcharging or unexplained hospital bill
- Billing for services or medicines not provided
- Failure to provide records or discharge documents
- Poor quality or deficient service
- Unethical or unsafe conduct
- Poor quality medicines

### Steps:

- Ask for an itemised bill, prescriptions, investigation reports, consent forms and discharge summary.
- Complain to the hospital's grievance officer or administrator.
- Approach the applicable State Medical Council, health authority, clinical-establishment authority or pharmacy regulator depending on the issue.
- For food, medicine or product safety, use the relevant FSSAI, CDSCO or State authority.
- Consider NCH or Consumer Commission for deficiency in service, subject to facts and evidence.

**Warning:** Medical negligence, professional misconduct and consumer-service deficiency may involve different legal forums. Urgent medical safety matters should be addressed first through medical care and appropriate authorities.

Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse), <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>

Keywords: hospital billing, medical negligence, healthcare complaint, medical records, deficiency in service

## Hospital Billing for Unused Services

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A hospital bill includes medicines, tests, rooms or services that the patient says were not provided or authorised.

#### Evidence:

- Itemised bill
- Discharge summary
- Medication administration record
- Prescription
- Payment proof
- Written complaint to hospital

#### Remedy:

- Ask the hospital billing department for an item-by-item explanation.
- Request correction and refund in writing.
- Escalate to the applicable State health or clinical-establishments authority.
- Use NCH or Consumer Commission if deficiency or unfair billing is established.

**Hindi Expression:** Hospital bill mein galat charges lage hain

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view\\_type=browse](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/15256?view_type=browse)

Keywords: hospital bill, itemised bill, wrong charges, refund, healthcare

## Electricity Billing and Supply Complaints

### Sector-Specific

#### Problems:

- Inflated bill
- Wrong meter reading
- Faulty meter
- Unjustified disconnection
- Frequent interruption
- Security deposit or connection issue

#### Steps:

- Complain to the electricity distribution licensee's complaint centre and obtain a complaint number.
- Photograph the meter reading and preserve recent bills.
- Escalate to the provider's internal grievance forum, Consumer Grievance Redressal Forum and Electricity Ombudsman under the applicable State electricity regulations.
- A Consumer Commission route may depend on the nature of the service, statutory forum and facts; seek advice before filing parallel proceedings.

#### Evidence:

- Bill

- Meter reading photographs
- Previous consumption history
- Complaint number
- Disconnection notice
- Payment records

**Source Urls:**

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/>

**Queries:**

- Wrong electricity bill complaint India
- Electricity meter reading dispute
- Unjustified power disconnection complaint
- Electricity Ombudsman escalation

**Keywords:**

- electricity bill
- meter reading
- disconnection
- CGRF
- Electricity Ombudsman

## LPG Complaints

Sector-Specific

**Problems:**

- Cylinder leakage
- Non-delivery after booking
- Overcharging
- Delivery without proper inspection
- Missing subsidy or account issue
- Damaged regulator or equipment

**Steps:**

- For leakage or immediate danger, turn off the regulator if safe, avoid flames or electrical switches, leave the area and contact the LPG emergency service or distributor.
- Complain to the distributor and oil company's official grievance channel.
- Preserve booking number, delivery slip, bill and photographs.
- Use NCH or the appropriate authority for unresolved consumer service issues.

**Source Urls:**

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>
- <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/>

**Queries:**

- LPG cylinder not delivered complaint
- LPG overcharging complaint
- Gas cylinder leakage what to do
- LPG booking refund issue

**Keywords:**

- LPG
- cylinder leakage
- delivery
- distributor
- overcharging

## Transport, Ticket Cancellation and Refunds

Travel and Transport

### Problems:

- Cancelled bus, train or flight without refund
- Refund delayed by airline, railway, bus operator or travel portal
- Hidden booking or convenience charges
- Baggage loss or damage
- Service materially different from the booking
- Hotel or travel package not provided as promised

### Steps:

- Check the ticket, fare rules and cancellation notice.
- Complain first to the carrier or booking intermediary using the official booking reference.
- Ask who is responsible for refund processing and keep the transaction trail.
- Escalate to the applicable transport regulator, railway or aviation grievance channel, NCH or Consumer Commission as appropriate.
- Do not assume a travel agent's terms eliminate all statutory consumer remedies.

### Evidence:

- Ticket or PNR
- Booking confirmation
- Cancellation SMS or email
- Payment record
- Refund promise
- Travel portal correspondence

**Warning:** Refund rules vary by transport mode, fare type, cancellation reason and booking channel. Check the current official rule for the particular service.

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/>

Keywords: travel refund, flight cancellation, train refund, bus ticket, airline complaint, booking portal

## Airline Refund Delay

Scenarios

**Problem:** A flight was cancelled but the promised refund has not been credited.

### Evidence:

- Ticket and PNR
- Cancellation email
- Refund reference
- Payment statement
- Airline or travel portal complaint number

### Remedy:

- Ask the airline or booking intermediary to identify the refund reference and date processed.
- Check whether the refund was sent to the original payment instrument.
- Escalate through the applicable aviation grievance channel and NCH.
- Consider Consumer Commission relief if deficient service and loss are established.

### Source Urls:

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>
- <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/>

### Queries:

- Airline cancelled flight refund not credited

- Travel portal refund delayed
- How to complain about airline refund?
- Flight cancellation consumer complaint

**Keywords:**

- airline refund
- PNR
- refund reference
- flight cancellation

## Train Ticket Refund

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A train was cancelled or a ticket was otherwise eligible for refund, but the refund was not processed.

**Evidence:**

- Ticket or PNR
- Cancellation SMS
- Payment receipt
- IRCTC or railway complaint number
- Bank statement

**Remedy:**

- Raise the issue with IRCTC or the relevant railway complaint channel.
- Keep the refund transaction reference.
- If the intermediary failed to provide the service or refund, use NCH or Consumer Commission where appropriate.

**Warning:** Railway refund rights depend on the ticket type, cancellation reason and current railway rules. Confirm the applicable rule from the official railway or IRCTC source.

*Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://www.irctc.co.in/>*

*Keywords: IRCTC, train cancellation, PNR, ticket refund*

## Builder, Flat and Real Estate Complaints

### Real Estate

**Problems:**

- Delayed possession
- Poor construction quality
- Failure to deliver promised amenities
- Hidden or unauthorised charges
- Failure to provide occupancy or completion documents
- Unfair cancellation or forfeiture
- Misleading project advertisement

**Steps:**

- Collect the allotment letter, agreement for sale, payment receipts, demand letters, project registration details and correspondence.
- Check the project and promoter on the relevant State RERA website.
- For a violation of RERA, file with the State RERA Authority or adjudicating officer as applicable.
- A Consumer Commission may also be relevant for consumer relief, but forum selection and parallel-proceeding issues require care.
- Ask for possession, interest, refund, defect rectification or compensation as legally appropriate.

**Evidence:**

- Builder-buyer agreement
- Allotment letter

- Payment receipts
- Possession promise
- Project brochure
- RERA registration
- Photographs and inspection reports

*Legal reference: Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, Section 31*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the\\_real\\_estate\\_\(regulation\\_and\\_development\)\\_act,\\_2016.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the_real_estate_(regulation_and_development)_act,_2016.pdf), <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/17064>*

*Keywords: RERA, builder, flat possession, real estate, agreement for sale, home buyer*

## Filing a Complaint Under RERA

Real Estate

**Rule:** Section 31 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 permits an aggrieved person to file a complaint with the RERA Authority or adjudicating officer, as applicable, for violation of the Act, rules or regulations against a promoter, allottee or real estate agent.

### Practical Steps:

- Identify the State RERA where the project is registered or located.
- Collect the project registration number and agreement documents.
- State the specific delay, defect, non-disclosure or violation.
- Request the relief recognised by the applicable RERA law and rules.
- Check appeal deadlines and filing fees on the official State RERA website.

**Warning:** RERA and consumer remedies may overlap in some cases. Do not choose a forum or withdraw a case without considering limitation, jurisdiction, res judicata, parallel proceedings and the relief sought.

*Legal reference: Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, Section 31*

*Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the\\_real\\_estate\\_\(regulation\\_and\\_development\)\\_act,\\_2016.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the_real_estate_(regulation_and_development)_act,_2016.pdf)*

*Keywords: RERA section 31, promoter, allottee, adjudicating officer, State RERA*

## School, College, Coaching and Online Education Complaints

Education Services

### Problems:

- Fees charged contrary to applicable rules
- Admission or course cancellation without refund
- Coaching course materially different from advertisement
- Online classes cancelled without refund
- Study material or promised services not provided
- Hidden charges for tests or materials
- Misleading placement or success claims

### Steps:

- Read the admission form, fee policy, refund policy and prospectus.
- Ask the institution for a written explanation and itemised calculation.
- Approach the relevant education department, university grievance mechanism, affiliating body or regulator.
- Report misleading coaching advertisements to CCPA where applicable.
- Use NCH or Consumer Commission for service deficiency where the legal requirements are met.

**Warning:** Whether a particular educational activity is a consumer service can depend on its nature, the institution, statutory framework and current case law. Obtain specific legal advice for complex disputes.

*Source: <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/regulations-made-under-consumer-protection-act-2019>, <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>*

*Keywords: education, school fees, coaching, online classes, refund, misleading advertisement*

## Online Classes Complaints

Education Services

### Problems:

- Classes cancelled without refund
- Poor quality teaching
- Promised faculty or schedule changed materially
- Hidden charges for study material
- Paid platform not accessible

### Evidence:

- Payment receipt
- Course advertisement
- Screenshots of class cancellation
- Schedule and attendance records
- Terms and refund policy

### Remedy:

- Raise a written complaint with the platform.
- Demand proportionate or full refund depending on the service not delivered.
- Use NCH and consider Consumer Commission proceedings for deficiency of service.

**Hindi Expression:** Online class band ho gayi, fees wapas chahiye

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/regulations-made-under-consumer-protection-act-2019>

Keywords: online education, coaching, course refund, deficiency of service

## SEBI-Regulated Investment Complaints

Securities and Investments

### Problems:

- Unauthorised trading or demat transaction
- Broker not transferring funds or securities
- Incorrect brokerage or charges
- Mutual-fund or intermediary service complaint
- Misleading investment communication
- Failure to resolve complaint by intermediary

### Steps:

- First complain to the concerned broker, depository participant, mutual fund, registrar or other regulated entity.
- Preserve contract notes, statements, account records, screenshots and complaint number.
- If unresolved, file a complaint through SEBI SCORES.
- Use the appropriate exchange, depository or investor grievance mechanism where directed.
- For suspected fraud or criminal conduct, report to police or cybercrime authorities.

**Scores Note:** The official SCORES portal is <https://scores.sebi.gov.in/>. SEBI's investor information states that a complainant should generally lodge the complaint against the concerned entity on SCORES within one year from the occurrence of the cause of action, subject to current rules and exceptions.

**Warning:** SCORES facilitates regulatory grievance redressal; it is not automatically a substitute for arbitration, civil proceedings, a Consumer Commission or criminal investigation.

Source: <https://scores.sebi.gov.in/>, [https://investor.sebi.gov.in/sebi\\_scores.html](https://investor.sebi.gov.in/sebi_scores.html), <https://investor.sebi.gov.in/securities-resolvedispute.html>

Keywords: SEBI, SCORES, broker, demat, mutual fund, investment complaint

## Public Transport Complaints

Transport

**Problems:**

- Overcrowding despite ticket charges
- Poor maintenance
- Unsafe conditions
- Failure to honour ticket or reservation
- Lost property or baggage

**Evidence:**

- Ticket
- Route and vehicle details
- Date and time
- Photographs or video
- Written complaint

**Remedy:**

- Report immediately to the transport operator or authority.
- Use the applicable State or central transport grievance channel.
- Seek refund or compensation through NCH or Consumer Commission where the service relationship and deficiency support it.

**Source Urls:**

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>

**Queries:**

- Public bus service complaint
- Transport ticket service deficient
- Bus overcrowding complaint
- Public transport refund complaint

**Keywords:**

- public transport
- bus complaint
- ticket
- poor service

## Mobile App and Digital Subscription Complaints

### Digital Services

**Problems:**

- Paid app not working
- Hidden subscription charges
- Unwanted ads despite payment
- Premium plan not activated
- Account disabled after payment
- Refund refused by app or platform

**Evidence:**

- App-store receipt
- Subscription confirmation
- Screenshots
- Bank or card statement
- Support ticket

**Remedy:**

- Complain to the app developer and app store payment channel.
- Cancel recurring payment through the official account settings and payment provider.
- Ask for refund and written confirmation.
- Use NCH, CCPA or Consumer Commission where applicable.

**Warning:** App-store refund procedures and statutory consumer remedies are separate. Keep proof of the actual developer, platform and payment intermediary.

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/file-uploads/latestnews/central-consumer-protection-authority-dark-patterns-guidelines-watermark-1565354.pdf>

Keywords: mobile app, subscription, digital service, app store, refund

## Internet Service and Broadband Complaints

Telecom and Broadband

### Problems:

- Slow internet despite promised speed
- Frequent disconnections
- Unexplained data or rental charges
- Failure to install or shift connection
- Security deposit not returned

### Evidence:

- Plan advertisement
- Speed-test results with dates
- Bill
- Outage messages
- Complaint docket number
- Installation or closure request

### Remedy:

- Complain to the internet service provider's complaint centre.
- Ask for bill correction, proportionate refund, restoration or closure confirmation.
- Appeal to the provider's Appellate Authority within the applicable TRAI timeline.
- Use NCH or Consumer Commission where appropriate.

### Source Urls:

- <https://www.trai.gov.in/faqcategory/redressal-consumer-grievances>
- <https://www.trai.gov.in/consumer-info/cgr/appellate-authority>

### Queries:

- Broadband speed lower than promised
- Internet frequent disconnection complaint
- ISP billing dispute India
- How to appeal broadband complaint?

### Keywords:

- internet service
- broadband
- speed
- disconnection
- TRAI appeal

## Everyday Consumer Protection Checklist

Awareness

### Before Purchase:

- Compare the total price, including delivery, taxes, convenience fees and recurring charges.
- Check seller identity, address, contact details, return policy and warranty.
- Verify relevant BIS mark, HUID, licence or registration where applicable.
- Be cautious of urgent countdowns, unrealistic discounts and guaranteed results.

### At Purchase:

- Ask for a proper invoice or receipt.
- Check MRP, net quantity, manufacturing or packing date, expiry or best-before date and product condition.
- Confirm model, colour, specification, warranty and promised delivery date.
- Use secure payment methods and never share OTP, PIN or passwords.

### After Purchase:

- Keep invoices, screenshots, payment records and correspondence.
- Report defects quickly and in writing.
- Record complaint numbers and deadlines.
- Do not discard packaging where authenticity, damage or return is disputed.
- Track the two-year Consumer Commission limitation period.

### Hindi Expressions:

- Bill sambhal ke rakho
- Expiry date check karo
- Pehle total price dekho
- OTP ya UPI PIN kisi ko mat batao
- Complaint number zaroor lo

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://www.bis.gov.in/bis-apps/?lang=en>,  
[https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology\\_act\\_2009.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4892/1/legalmetrology_act_2009.pdf)

Keywords: consumer awareness, invoice, MRP, expiry, OTP, UPI PIN, evidence

## Which Authority Should I Approach

### Authorities and Escalation

**General Consumer Grievance:** Seller or service provider → National Consumer Helpline → Consumer Commission through official e-Jagriti or applicable filing process.

**Bank Or Nbf:** Regulated entity grievance channel → RBI Complaint Management System or Ombudsman if covered and preconditions are met.

**Upi Or Payment Fraud:** Bank or payment provider immediately → 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in → RBI or other appropriate regulator where applicable.

**Insurance:** Insurer grievance officer → IRDAI Bima Bharosa → Insurance Ombudsman or Consumer Commission where eligible.

**Telecom:** Telecom complaint centre → provider's Appellate Authority, commonly through 198 → other appropriate remedy.

**Food:** Seller or manufacturer → FSSAI Food Safety Connect or State Food Safety authority → NCH or Consumer Commission for consumer relief.

**Bis Or Hallmark:** Seller or jeweller → BIS Care or BIS complaint channel → NCH or Consumer Commission for refund or compensation.

**Securities:** Broker or regulated intermediary → exchange or depository grievance route where applicable → SEBI SCORES.

**Real Estate:** Promoter or agent → State RERA Authority or adjudicating officer → appeal or other consumer remedy as legally appropriate.

**Weights And Measures:** Seller → State Legal Metrology authority → NCH or Consumer Commission for consumer relief.

**Criminal Conduct:** Police, emergency service or cybercrime authorities; regulatory and consumer complaints do not replace criminal reporting.

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>, <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>, <https://bimabharosa.irdai.gov.in/>,  
<https://www.trai.gov.in/faqcategory/redressal-consumer-grievances>, <https://fssai.gov.in/food-safety-connect>, <https://scores.sebi.gov.in/>,  
<https://cybercrime.gov.in/>, <https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/pages/e-jagriti>

Keywords: escalation, authority, regulator, consumer commission, NCH, RBI, IRDAI, TRAI, FSSAI, SEBI, BIS, RERA

## Poor Repair or Service

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A service centre or contractor fails to repair a product properly, delays the repair or returns it with additional damage.

**Evidence:**

- Original invoice
- Warranty
- Service receipt or job sheet
- Before-and-after photographs
- Messages showing promised completion date
- Inspection or expert report if needed

**Remedy:**

- Demand correction, proper repair, replacement, refund or compensation as facts justify.
- Request a written reason if the service centre claims misuse or out-of-warranty condition.
- Escalate to the manufacturer, NCH or Consumer Commission.

**Hindi Expression:** Service centre ne product theek nahi kiya

*Legal reference: Consumer Protection Act, 2019, Section 2(11), Section 39*

*Source: <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15276/1/210422.pdf>*

*Keywords: repair, service centre, deficiency, job sheet, compensation*

## Paid Premium Subscription but Basic Service Received

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A consumer paid for a premium online plan but received only a basic plan or cannot access promised features.

**Evidence:**

- Payment receipt
- Subscription confirmation
- Feature comparison
- Screenshots
- Support ticket

**Remedy:**

- Ask the provider to activate the promised plan or provide a refund.
- Cancel recurring billing if the issue is not corrected.
- Escalate to the provider grievance officer, NCH or Consumer Commission.

**Source Urls:**

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>
- [https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules\\_1732703966.pdf](https://consumeraffairs.gov.in/public/upload/files/E%20commerce%20rules_1732703966.pdf)

**Queries:**

- Paid premium plan received basic service
- Online subscription features missing
- Digital subscription refund complaint
- Service provider not honouring premium plan

**Keywords:**

- premium subscription
- basic plan
- digital service
- refund
- deficiency

## Wrong Electricity Bill

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A consumer is charged much more than actual usage or receives a bill based on an incorrect meter reading.

**Evidence:**

- Current meter photograph with date
- Electricity bill
- Previous bills
- Meter testing request
- Complaint number

**Remedy:**

- Submit a meter-reading and bill-correction complaint to the distribution company.
- Ask for meter testing and a revised bill.
- Escalate to the applicable Consumer Grievance Redressal Forum or Electricity Ombudsman.
- Consider other remedies only after checking the applicable sector rules.

**Hindi Expression:** Bijli ka bill galat hai

Source: <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>

Keywords: electricity bill, meter, billing dispute, CGRF, Ombudsman

## Wrong or Undisclosed Bank Charge

### Scenarios

**Problem:** A bank deducts an annual fee, penalty or service charge that the consumer says was not disclosed or was incorrectly applied.

**Evidence:**

- Bank statement
- Account terms and tariff schedule
- Charge notification
- Written complaint
- Bank response

**Remedy:**

- Ask the bank to identify the contractual or regulatory basis for the charge.
- Request reversal if incorrectly applied or not properly disclosed.
- Escalate to the bank's nodal grievance officer and RBI CMS after the applicable precondition.

**Hindi Expression:** Bank ne bina bataye charge kaat liya

Source: <https://www.rbi.org.in/CommonPerson/english/Scripts/PressReleases.aspx?Id=3340>, <https://cms.rbi.org.in/>

Keywords: bank charge, annual fee, tariff, RBI CMS, refund

## Airline Refund Delay

### Scenarios

**Problem:** Flight cancelled but refund not processed by the airline or booking intermediary.

**Evidence:**

- Ticket
- Cancellation email
- Refund request
- Payment receipt
- Booking reference

**Remedy:**

- Complain to the airline and intermediary in writing.
- Obtain the refund reference or written reason for delay.
- Use the applicable aviation grievance channel and NCH.

- Consider Consumer Commission proceedings for deficient service if appropriate.

**Queries:**

- Flight cancelled but refund pending
- Airline refund complaint India
- Travel agent not returning ticket money
- Consumer case for flight refund

**Keywords:**

- airline
- refund
- flight cancellation
- travel portal

**Source Urls:**

- <https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>

## Employment Dispute Is Usually Not a Consumer Complaint

### Scope Boundaries

**Problem:** An employer withholds salary, benefits or employment dues.

**Correct Route:** This is ordinarily an employment or labour dispute, not a Consumer Commission matter, because an employee generally does not hire the employer's service as a consumer.

**Remedy:**

- Approach the labour department, labour commissioner, appropriate tribunal or court.
- Use the employment contract, salary slips, attendance records and written demand.
- Seek legal advice for limitation and forum selection.

**Warning:** Do not automatically file an employment dispute before a Consumer Commission. The correct forum depends on the employment relationship and applicable labour law.

Source: <https://labour.gov.in/>

Keywords: employment, salary, labour dispute, scope boundary, labour commissioner

## Land Purchase Dispute

### Real Estate and Scope

**Problem:** A person is cheated in a land purchase, faces title problems or does not receive promised possession.

**Evidence:**

- Agreement or sale deed
- Payment receipts
- Title documents
- Encumbrance or registration records
- Advertisements
- Correspondence

**Remedy:**

- For suspected fraud or forgery, report to police and seek civil legal advice.
- For a registered real-estate project, examine the State RERA route.
- For consumer service deficiency or misleading representation, assess NCH or Consumer Commission eligibility.
- Consult a property lawyer before signing settlement or relinquishing title rights.

**Warning:** Pure title disputes, criminal cheating and land-record issues may require civil court, police or revenue authorities rather than only a Consumer Commission.

Source: [https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the\\_real\\_estate\\_\(regulation\\_and\\_development\)\\_act,\\_2016.pdf](https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15131/1/the_real_estate_(regulation_and_development)_act,_2016.pdf),  
<https://consumerhelpline.gov.in/>

Keywords: land dispute, property fraud, title, RERA, revenue authority, civil court

## AI Legal Safety Rules

AI/Legal Safety

### Rules:

- Provide general legal awareness, not personalised legal representation.
- Do not promise a result, refund, compensation or guaranteed success.
- Distinguish a regulator complaint, NCH grievance, Consumer Commission case, civil proceeding and criminal complaint.
- Cite the applicable Act, section, rule, authority and official source where available.
- State when a rule is fact-specific, subject to exclusions or likely to change.
- For urgent safety, medical injury, criminal fraud, limitation expiry, large financial loss or property title disputes, encourage timely professional advice.
- Never ask a consumer to share OTP, UPI PIN, card PIN, password or remote-access details.
- Use only verified official URLs and do not invent complaint numbers, deadlines or legal provisions.

*Keywords: legal awareness, AI safety, disclaimer, official sources, professional advice, privacy*

## Corrections and Data-Quality Notes

Dataset Quality

### Corrections:

- The original dataset's ₹50 lakh, ₹2 crore and National Commission thresholds are retained and confirmed against the Consumer Protection (Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions) Rules, 2021.
- The original NCH phone numbers and 8 AM to 8 PM timing are retained and supplemented with the official WhatsApp and SMS number.
- The original generic instruction to approach a Consumer Commission after every sector complaint has been qualified because many sectors have mandatory or specialised grievance routes, and some disputes involve separate statutory forums.
- The original employment-dispute record is corrected: unpaid salary and employment benefits are ordinarily labour or employment matters, not ordinary consumer complaints.
- The original land-dispute record is qualified: title, fraud and revenue issues may require police, civil court, RERA or revenue authorities; a Consumer Commission is not automatically the correct forum.
- Generic statements such as 'file complaint under deficiency of service' are retained only where the facts can establish a consumer-service relationship and deficiency.
- Current portal links should be checked before deployment because government filing systems and URLs can change.

**Deduplication Note:** Near-duplicate records about online shopping, wrong delivery, refunds, banking, telecom, food and education were consolidated where the consolidation preserved the original practical scenarios and added legal qualifications.

*Keywords: corrections, outdated, duplicates, scope, data quality, forum selection*